

Direct and Indirect Speech

Year 5 | Grammar and Phonics

Aussie Primary
Academy

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 | AC9E5LA08 | Year 5 | Understanding Language — Speech and Dialogue

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to use direct and indirect (reported) speech correctly, including punctuating dialogue accurately.

KEY IDEA

DIRECT speech uses the **EXACT** words said, inside quotation marks: She said, 'I am tired.'

INDIRECT speech reports what was said **WITHOUT** quotation marks, often changing the tense: She said that she was tired. Note the verb tense shift (am → was).

WARM UP — QUICK CHECK!

Is this direct or indirect speech? Write how you know:

'The teacher announced that the excursion was cancelled.'

A — PUNCTUATE THE DIALOGUE

Add the missing quotation marks, capital letters and punctuation:

1. the dog is really hungry said Mia looking at the empty bowl

2. can we please go to the beach tomorrow asked Tom hopefully

3. i have finished all my homework announced Priya proudly

B — DIRECT → INDIRECT SPEECH

Example: "I am happy," said Leo. → Leo said that he was happy. (am → was)

1. "I will finish my homework," said Zoe.

2. "We are going to the beach today," said Mum.

3. "The train has already left," the conductor told us.

C — INDIRECT → DIRECT SPEECH

Change each sentence into direct speech with correct punctuation:

1. Sam said that he was very excited about the upcoming trip.

2. She told him that he should bring a raincoat.

D — WRITE A DIALOGUE

Write a 4-line dialogue between two friends deciding what to do on the weekend. Use correct direct speech punctuation throughout:

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Indirect speech — no quotation marks, uses 'that', verb tense has shifted.

A1: "The dog is really hungry," said Mia, looking at the empty bowl.

A2: "Can we please go to the beach tomorrow?" asked Tom hopefully.

A3: "I have finished all my homework!" announced Priya proudly.

B1: Zoe said that she would finish her homework.

B2: Mum said that they were going to the beach that day.

B3: The conductor told us that the train had already left.

C1: "I am very excited about the upcoming trip," said Sam.

C2: "You should bring a raincoat," she told him.

D: Accept any 4-line dialogue with consistent correct punctuation: quotation marks, capital letters, comma/question mark/exclamation mark before the closing quote.

High Five! You are a Language Champion! ✓
Colour a star for each section you completed successfully:



EXTENSION / CHALLENGE

Find a page of dialogue in a story. Choose 3 lines of direct speech and rewrite them as indirect (reported) speech. Notice and explain how the verb tenses change.

PARENT TIP

Retell a conversation from your day together — try both ways: 'She said, "..."' vs 'She said that...'. Notice how the words change and how meaning stays the same.

TEACHER TIP

Use comic strips or short video clips with dialogue. Students write the dialogue first in direct speech, then convert to indirect speech, annotating the tense shifts they make.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- ☐ I can correctly punctuate direct speech using quotation marks
- ☐ I can convert direct speech to indirect speech with correct tense changes
- ☐ I can write my own dialogue using accurate speech punctuation